# Errata

**On Blair, Coppock and Moor (2020), *American Political Science Review* 114(4)**

This note lists eleven corrections to "When to Worry about Sensitivity Bias: A Social Reference Theory and Evidence from 30 Years of List Experiments," published in the *American Political Science Review* 114(4), doi 10.1017/S0003055420000374: ten misstated numbers and one sentence that describes the estimates incorrectly as a result. **None of them changes a conclusion of the paper.** Ten are in the article's text and one, entry 8, is in its online appendix. Every one but the last restates a quantity the article also prints in Table 4, and in each case Table 4 is right and the sentence is not. The sentences that carry the paper's findings, and Table 4 itself, are unaffected.

Every number in a corrected sentence below is computed from the deposited replication archive (10.7910/DVN/YUXHZT) at the time this document is rendered, including the numbers that were not wrong. The code and output supporting each correction are at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/blair_coppock_moor_2020.

**Bold marks the corrections, and only what is bold has changed.** Everything else in a corrected sentence reads exactly as the page prints it, figures included. A figure an entry does not correct is recomputed from the deposit like every other, then stated at the article's own precision, usually whole points; each one reproduces the published figure, and this document refuses to render if one does not. A corrected figure is stated to one decimal place, so a correction smaller than a point can be seen at all. Where the fuller value of an uncorrected figure matters it is given in the note beneath the entry.

The first six entries are substantive: the number a reader would quote is wrong by more than a point, and the first two turn on a sign. The last five differ from the article's own figure, in Table 4 or for the last in Figure 2a, by less than a point, which is exactly why they need a decimal to be visible at all.

## 1. The sexual orientation underreporting estimate carries the wrong sign

> For questions thought to be subject to overreporting, the average estimate of sensitivity bias is –2 percentage points; for underreporting, the estimate is **+2** percentage points.

Corrected:

> For questions thought to be subject to overreporting, the average estimate of sensitivity bias is –2 percentage points; for underreporting, the estimate is **–1.0** percentage points.

Table 4 prints –0.01 for the same quantity. The paper's conclusion for this literature, that sensitivity bias in questions about attitudes towards gays and lesbians cannot be distinguished from zero, is unaffected.

## 2. Only one of the two sexual orientation estimates has an unexpected sign

> **These estimates both have** an unexpected sign relative to the **predictions and are not** distinguishable from zero.

Corrected:

> **Only the overreporting estimate has** an unexpected sign relative to the **predictions, and neither is** distinguishable from zero.

The sentence follows directly from the misstated figure corrected above. Underreporting predicts a negative difference between the direct question and the list experiment, and the underreporting average is –1.0 points, which is the sign predicted. Overreporting predicts a positive difference, and the overreporting average is –1.8 points, which is not. Both credible intervals contain zero, so the second half of the sentence stands as published.

## 3. The racial prejudice 95 per cent predictive interval

> The 50% predictive interval reaches from +1 to +7 points, but the 95% predictive interval admits large negative biases (**–16** points) to large positive biases up to **16** points.

Corrected:

> The 50% predictive interval reaches from +1 to +7 points, but the 95% predictive interval admits large negative biases (**–5.2** points) to large positive biases up to **12.8** points.

Table 4 prints [–0.05, 0.12] for this interval. The lower bound in the text is roughly three times the one the table carries.

## 4. The width of the turnout 95 per cent predictive interval

> This uncertainty is also reflected in the very wide predictive intervals: the 50% interval is 13 points wide and the 95% interval is **45** points wide.

Corrected:

> This uncertainty is also reflected in the very wide predictive intervals: the 50% interval is 13 points wide and the 95% interval is **37.4** points wide.

Table 4's own interval for turnout is [–0.12, 0.26], which is 38 points wide, so the sentence disagrees with the table as well as with the data.

## 5. The vote buying predictive intervals

> In the bottom row of Figure 4a, we show the 50% predictive interval from –14 to **−2** points and the 95% predictive interval from **−27** to **+10** points.

Corrected:

> In the bottom row of Figure 4a, we show the 50% predictive interval from –14 to **−2.7** points and the 95% predictive interval from **−24.9** to **+8.1** points.

Table 4 prints [–0.14, –0.03] and [–0.25, 0.08] for the same two intervals.

## 6. The width of the religious prejudice credible interval

> This estimate is in the expected direction, but the credible interval is **13** points wide and includes zero.

Corrected:

> This estimate is in the expected direction, but the credible interval is **11.4** points wide and includes zero.

Table 4's own interval for religious prejudice is [–0.07, 0.04], which is 11 points wide.

## 7. The upper bound of the vote buying credible interval

> In the top row is the estimated average sensitivity bias across studies for vote-buying questions (black diamond), –8 points with a 95% credible interval stretching from –13 to **–3** points.

Corrected:

> In the top row is the estimated average sensitivity bias across studies for vote-buying questions (black diamond), –8 points with a 95% credible interval stretching from –13 to **–3.7** points.

Table 4 prints –0.04 for the same bound.

## 8. The average bias across all underreporting studies

> Second, as shown in Table 4, the average sensitivity bias in the case of underreporting is **–3** points (SE: 1 point).

Corrected:

> Second, as shown in Table 4, the average sensitivity bias in the case of underreporting is **–3.5** points (SE: 1 point).

Table 4 prints –0.04, which rounds to –4 rather than –3 at whole-point precision.

## 9. The lower bound of the racial prejudice credible interval

> For questions about racial prejudice, our summary guess is that if anything, subjects overreport racist attitudes by approximately 4 points (95% CI **–3** to +9).

Corrected:

> For questions about racial prejudice, our summary guess is that if anything, subjects overreport racist attitudes by approximately 4 points (95% CI **–2.4** to +9).

Table 4 prints –0.02 for the same bound, which is –2 rather than –3 at whole-point precision. The estimate the sentence hedges as "approximately 4 points" is 3.8 and is correct at the precision it states, so it is left as published.

## 10. The lower bound of the authoritarian overreporting predictive interval

> Based on 21 studies, our meta-analysis estimate of the average level for studies in which overreporting is predicted is +14 points and the 50% predictive interval suggests a likely level of sensitivity bias between **+4** to +24 points.

Corrected:

> Based on 21 studies, our meta-analysis estimate of the average level for studies in which overreporting is predicted is +14 points and the 50% predictive interval suggests a likely level of sensitivity bias between **+4.5** to +24 points.

Table 4 prints 0.05 for the same bound.

## 11. The sample size at which a list experiment becomes preferable on RMSE grounds

> For a study with 1,000 subjects, the bias must be greater than **5.5** points to prefer a list experiment; at 2,000, the bias must be greater than 4 points.

Corrected:

> For a study with 1,000 subjects, the bias must be greater than **5.6** points to prefer a list experiment; at 2,000, the bias must be greater than 4 points.

The RMSE indifference curve the article's own Figure 2a plots crosses at 5.57 points at this sample size, so a bias of 5.5 points would not in fact prefer the list experiment. The companion bound at 2,000 subjects crosses at 3.94 and holds as stated.